



thankies to our hard
working angels <3

geli

story



gracie

art + lettering

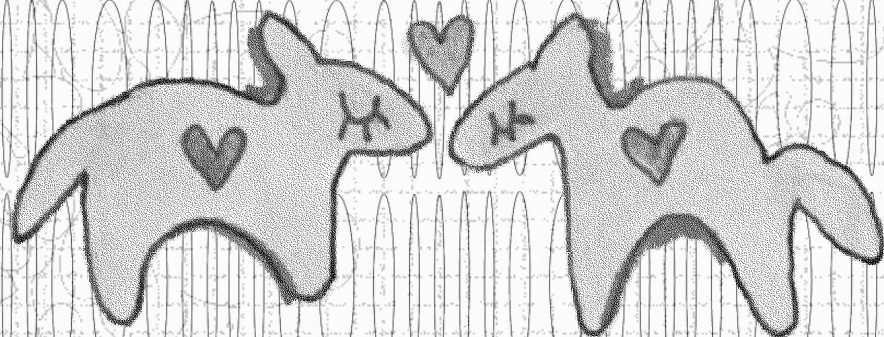


Special Thanks

frankie & kelly & flannery
& nico & niko & john <3



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please send

thank you

**Issue
Four**

MY PLEA



A LETTER TO A FRIEND

Mon enfant, ma sœur... I miss you terribly. I am called to write for you at all hours of the night, rising like a somnambulist, feeling my soul rend and burst with the sentiment of letters.

Now that our studies have terminated, must we never again "hang"? (Do you resent my using such low colloquium... before you begrudge me, note at least that I addressed you by your *nom de préférence*.)

I've moved to Le Ville, ostensibly to pursue my craft, but this has yet to find a concrete or financial expression. I was considering making rounds through the establishments of my trade: Café Egyptologique, Monocle Bar, Joan of Arc Club- but at each stab I am repelled by lavasciousity... not a soul to honor the trade with the reverence, awe, and humility it merits. I believe, as you well know, the highest function of art will not be found by chasing the above-all "transcendent" (which contrary to popular opinion, is not found in those withering pleasures of the flesh; sex is but an animal thing, debasing the mind and body, and arousal is nothing but a state of chained terror, and pursuit of its false promise is the greatest delusion today's would-be poets suffer under).

No, art's fulfillment will not be found in beauty - art must suborn itself to sociality. Art must be the expression of the subjective, which creates the basis to relate self to self, self to others. This is the foundation for future understandings; a perpetually reiterated social-art; a great chain of alignment. Culture must be conceived of as technology, science, modernity- in a word, progress. It is the perfection of the spirit, the spirit of civilization which perfects itself through conceptualization, struggle, eternally, progressively. When I commence to write, it will be in service of this redemptive vision of culture.

Unfortunately, my status as an unemployed loser denies me a promenade upon the literary path. I'm left to fritter away the hours strolling less-picaresque avenues, beneath wasting and sickly trees. How I wish my winters were still spent in bed with you; those cold boarding school nights, a hair's breadth apart. When called to *faire pipi* in the dead of night, we steal away to squat together o'r washbasin and warm ourselves, if not by embrace, then by aura of shared expellation! *Hélas!* I would die content simply as your plutonic companion, your sister, in a bond forever unconsummated (if this pleases you[!]). I have enclosed a poem that speaks, I believe, to my affections for you, as well as a crude translation of my own devising.





Lesser minds at first glance
cry: obscene! and then look no
further; but if one listens
close for the plaintive,
desperate cry, there arises a
paeon to greater, higher ideals
of love than those found in the
canon of roses and bosoms...

*so one night i wanna
when l'heure strikes voluptuous
move like a creep
over to your bodily delights*

*to hurt your happy body
to kill your tits
surprise your leg
by carving a hole in it*

*oh, stultifying sweetness!
moving towards that new hole
that invites me
to put my venom in my sister*

I walk not just to pass the
hours, but deliberately and
consciously, accumulating images
suitable to my work. The streets
here are rarely attended to by
the hoses and locomotive
carriages of the "*pompes de
merde*". Women advertised as
snake dancers crowd under
tasseled umbrellas, muttering
mechanical bawdy addresses one
is near-tempted to heed once
having registered the intriguing
look of boredom and ennui *sur
leur visage*. The shared
ownership of misery lends the
already arousing allure a
vaporous promise of comradeship,
that sweet psychological connection
so far above the tawdry bauble
of commingling offered by the
loathsome establishments that
bestow upon our city its
revolting sensualist prestige.



The Vorticist Lounge, Dawn
Rosé, Symbolists Siesta, The Far
East Cultural Attaché, each fill
me with a disgust beyond myself,
at our present state, at our
fallen state! This disgust is
one I experience with increasing
frequency, this distaste for the
world, for things, for myself.

I have a deeply troubled mind.
My interior space disturbs me,
demands I flee from it. This is
not a flight from a repressed
horror (though these reflections
do provoke a confused repulsion
in many), but instead refers to
what I have termed an
inexplicable mercuriality.

When I was a child, I would
think: "something good will
happen today" or "my mom will
give me candy for no reason." I
would tell Mother, as the
intensity of these thoughts
disturbed me. They happened by
my dresser, and by way of the
toilet...

Today it is the same. "A woman
will be nice to me for no
reason" (later I will record
these occurrences meticulously,
as instances demonstrating an
uncanny power of actualization).
These relate to a similar
impulse to "peacock" my
libidinal prowess, which has the
effect of ennobling the vows
that have come to define my life
and give it an ethical basis.)

Later in my infancy, I
began to interrogate the
question of "orgasms." This was
prompted by hearing across the
schoolyard, children linking to
the-entirely-novel-to-me concept
of "orgasms" to "feeling good".

Needless to say, this association had initially dissuaded me from any such dilettantism. I say initially, as soon came subsequent successes which presaged further forays in frolics.

Although the flower of my youth has closed, it all having been over since 25 (prev. 23, prev. 17), I still fear the potency of those inner movements, those chthonic tremors which fill me with an impotent dread.)

Given that this is the 12th letter you'll have received since your departure, I hope you will feel perhaps tempted to write, if at least in service of the paperial debt I'm owed.

Adoringly yours,
S

LETTER TO FATHER

Father littéralement envoyez-me money

LETTER TO MOTHER

Dearest Mother,

I've received your cake and cookies, as well as allowance, rent money, and money for the creditors. All from Father's dividends, presumably, or should I say: "my" dividends, "my" share of his loathsome enterprise. I suppose he expected that certain responsibilities and opportunities would prompt me to take on the personage of a mature foreman. He misapprehends my nature. I intend to meet his advances with bold refusal; an overt challenge which demands – stop sending me money! I would rather become destitute, and whereupon feeling your familial honor sullied, you should come to beg the privilege of sheltering and clothing me, I will be given the opportunity to spit in Father's face as I have so-long desired.

I harbor only comparatively mild ill will towards you, Mother, resenting primarily your aptness to shelter and defend my aggressors; a malignant tendency (however, one lent a not-inconsiderable nobility by its matronly alignment). Namely, I condemn your inability to reprimand or contain Father's improprieties.

She was drunk at this point and led me into her private chamber. She shoved me on the bed, hit me over the back of the head, and forced my ass into the air. She proceeded to fuck me. I was quiet, which she noticed, so she got more aggressive. I cried out. Later I climaxed. She continued for a minute and then sat on the side of the bed. She apologized and said, "I'm not really feeling myself. I think I just needed the distraction." I said "no worries!" and noticing the late hour, departed to reclaim sound rest in my own quarters.

She is married to a high-ranking colonel, who secured for her the portfolio she oversees. I flew into quite an indignancy at this news and swiftly committed myself to the mission that has since come to define my life, even at the expense of my artistic production: I would free her from those shackles of convention that have placed her in bondage, denying her liberty, authenticity, happiness.

I found her in a café and proposed that we elope. Though her response was quick in coming and just as sharp, I was reminded the deepest and most enduring bonds are those written in blood and struggle.

I will continue to provide you updates as I crusade in the name of our dear friends' happiness.

LETTER TO FATHER

Dearest Father,

I am very pregnant, with quintuplets. I am also dying. I have been diagnosed with a particularly virulent strain of tuberculosisphallus. The treatment is working, and I begin to feel my strength revive. But they tell me it is too expensive for me to continue! If you wish, like me, to see this litter born, I beg you, send me my allowance, with haste!

LETTER TO SISTER

Dearest Sister,

I am writing, foremost, to report that the sorry promise I made in the last letter was never carried through. I have returned to the city after a trip abroad – New Prussian Maryland is as beautiful as ever! These travels of mine are hardly worth mentioning, save that they cost me time and trouble subtracted from the valuable contributions to literature I could've made in the intervening period. Although I am of course eager to both reply to the concerns raised in your previous correspondences and inquire as to the state of your affairs, I have something that should be of urgent interest to you – I have spoken again with our Salaïe.

I saw her in the boulevard, clad in a men's military dress of olive and medal. She was my vision, my valkyrie... Naturally, she had placed herself in the good graces of the victorious party, as befits someone of her insuppressible spirit. Her great mind and passions truly lend themselves to such an endeavor as "colonial administrator".

Us unruly subjects ought to be grateful to have those such as her to tutor us in the cultural-socio superiority of monarchistic tradition and of the dignity which obedience bestows upon the slave!

After a brief discussion, in which I shared my joy at our reunion, I was swept away to her apartment. The decor was dignified, elegant, and yet whimsical. Grecian statues glittered alongside anthropological wonders. It was as though I had stepped into an archaeological wonder of the world, the sunken treasure of civilization; strange dolls danced from the lamp, and horned masks sat alongside billings from the most wonderful and elegant operas, featuring women in displays and garb of erotic mystery.

I began to explore her cabinets, drawn to the allure of fabulous china sets illustrated with silverfish; she recounted to me the enigmatic anecdote of its origins as she poured herself a glass of the most top-shelf *spiritueux* ! I informed her of my intention to seek employment and of the success I expected to encounter in my literary endeavors. I told her I was no longer the quivering, feeble dependent she last knew in our youth. That she no longer need scold me for my ignorance of struggle, that I understood her life's *travaux*, but that I forgave her for her chastisement because she had then been right.

His attempts at discipline were always ill aimed, targeting perceived offenses with effete spanks in the seat of a closed carriage, training me only to stoke the roiling resentment that found its penultimate expression in my suicide attempts at age 6, age 7, age 8, 8½ (and I need but allude to those circumstances which brought me to my first of many forced confessionals). His standards of costume are equally objectionable in their rigidity; reprimanding sister as a *fille publique* while alluding to his own arousal at my "improper" invert tendencies, even once confessing erotic titillation at my depiction in a *document pour artistes* sold to him as *Mineur Nu* (which he discovered through a betrayal I suffered at the hands of that perfidite and stupid bitch Cousine O).

Your greatest act of kindness was drawn from the font of the same matronly virtue I've hitherto chastised. Your permittance of Salaïe's sojourn in our manor was a gift of infinite patience (if not too, the perfect portrait of your weakness). Though you likely suspect, our friendship has been one of considerable duress. Her melancholia imprison me as though a trap – nothing but the alleviation of her strange conditions, psychical and physical, concerned me; I experienced a total subjugation to the prevention of any one of her "attacks", around which rose a prison of rules:

impossible desires, unspeakable agonies, and implacable cries of the soul that if spoken, would meet her disgust, rejection, and punishment, be it in the form of a sharp remark or a resounding smack, in response to which I could only enact a shameful retreat to one of those public urinals or open air bidets which provided me convenient alibi for reprieve from beratement. Most of all, my ordeal must be accredited to her consummate, unshakable performance, her denial of anything "wrong" in our present situation. I of course, miss her terribly and long for the day whereupon she may admit, "I know what I've done to you, what torture you've suffered on my behalf – I hereby release you from my bonds." In absence of those words, I long for her terribly, long for the comfort of her presence, which reassures me I have not yet failed in my task of guardianship.

My attempts at engaging the social world of my milieu have so far been unsuccessful. Here I am speaking of those who share my shameful, "*anti-physique*" predilections [I am here anguished by the inadequacy of language, the ways in which your understanding me is made impossible, whether due to some accident of character on your side, or the inexpressibility of my interiority.]

I am equally embittered as I am endlessly jealous of those of my specie who indulge their youth with dance, sex, *les fumeries d'opium*; though I know of course, beauty and youth are a trap that encloses and damns the weak of mind and spirit, forsaking them to an inevitable and grand disappointment should they be denied the blessing of an early death, or should they not enact it themselves. Any sensible discipline of the sensual path knows well the fulfillment is found in suicide.

I am now tired and must lie down. I shall write again. I challenge Father to send more funds, now that my gauntlet has been so evidently evidenced.

I'm unsure of how to sign off this letter appropriately, so this acknowledgement of unsurety should suffice I hope.

LETTER TO SISTER

Childhood. Our youth. The market-garden, the charnel row, lean-to greenhouses shoved against the hungry corner of the lightwell. In the streets of those days, pushing younger kids on the ground, punching them, tripping them. Later, getting choked out and fingered by the older ones.

Playing wrong: a day late to Artillery vs. Light Brigade, being too into playing "statue". [Sexually]. I was a sexual child, unfortunately. Sorry.

That was where the hate began. Or despair. Or ennui. Scratch all of the above. Not really. I would think, do I love Mother, Father, Sister? No. What does that make me feel. Nothin'. Death by scalding, struck by carriage? Nothin'. Note that I made a pained smile.

Sorry about all the stuff I did, whatever stuff you remember that I don't and vice versa. Not important if you were mad, I forgive you, but if you're currently mad at me don't read this letter.

Regarding the rumors, I haven't noticed anything really. That goes for the ameriprussian siege, the meteor, and doubly for Dr. du Mal's machinations. Nonetheless, god willing, one of those happens. Cannons, blast me, stars, crush me, villains, corrupt me! I look at people on the street, and think, god how stupid, and another person passes and I look; an endless procession of pointless phenomena. Breathing is the most stupid thing I do. If only plague, hussars, syphilis from all the sex I have, could've extinguished me sometime between ages two to four. Or sooner!

I was unfortunately carried far afloat by current, whose strength drove me further and further from those to whom I had been committed my soul's affection to.

When I came to, I was being pulled aboard. Grateful to my rescuers, and hesitant to suppress the vows I had made in the *Concordance of Equals*, I elected to honestly explain my position to them: though they were my country's enemies, I harbored no ill-will to them; I would sooner surrender myself than fight in a war of brother against brother; in fact, I had been attempting to surrender myself since I left Le Ville only there had so far been no one from the other side to accept me, so thankfully, here we are at last.

I was placed in a small cage chained to the deck, wherein I was exposed to the elements and torments of my captors, pitched endlessly from side to side and often left to hang overboard, another albatross laid low by man's sadistries. I lived in hope of being freed – if not in an act of charity, then to honor my affinities with the fairer sex (or to exploit them!). This possibility was barred, it turns out, as my tormentors' recent encounter with a maritime evangelist had initiated an ascetic life of abstinence and purity.

It was during my feeding hour that the skies darkened; while bent over my food bowl, I witnessed a swarm of descending forms enact a sanguine eclipse;

the waters churned, great flayed leviathans arose from the depths, sharks foaming bloodily at rosé tissue. Having conquered the sun, those descending forms rushed to cloud the skies; one could imagine, in that moment, they had communicated something of true revelation through the formation of subtle images by their thronging. It was then I realized that these were not soldiers of any known wartime faction, but rather hordes of those terrible etheric beings that arrived with the appearance of the beast of Low-Crawling. Weightless and silent, their butchery proceeded without pathos or grace.

I threw myself overboard, clinging to what had hitherto been my prison. Bouncing off a whale, I sunk into the depths. And then floated back up, and then floated for a while, and then, and then, on and on...

Until I reached an island. On that island were a colony of devoted monks, who had intended to live off the land in communion with one another, but it had devolved into a *folie à beaucoup* of antinomian excess culminating in mass suicide. I found them dead because I had missed the orgy phase of it.

Now I am hungry and dying and in dire need of aid; if you, the recipient, have a drop of mercy running through your veins, send me money, expeditiously!

MESSAGE IN A BOTTLE

This, I dread, shall be my last will and testament! It all began when I agreed, it should be noted, reluctantly, to join an expedition set for the far l'est. The events of the Brumaire Folly, combined with the unforgiving social environs of the time, forbade me to continue life in the grand ol' capital. When I heard rumors of the line-breakers and their dashing smuggerly feats, I committed myself to joining the first *plounger* I could get aboard.

Life beneath the waves was atypical, but I swiftly adapted to the customs of these *hommes à tête bubblié*. There was an initial wave of fear, upon my discovery that their intention was to contribute to the war effort a doomed voyage "around the claw." There was stationed on the eastern shore, a detachment tasked with defending the enemy military secret depository. I believe they intended to enroll my feminine qualities in one of their *schéma d'infiltration*.

Luckily, there was a mutiny shortly after we surfaced in open waters. The captain was strung up by his feet, beaten with sticks, head shaved, spit on.

It was decided that the vessel would renounce the struggle of blood, and, rechristened in the name of the *Concordance of Equals*, seek for neutral soil. The men proceeded to destroy any evidence of national character, renouncing ethnic, civic, or patriotic loyalties in favor of the universal fraternity of men. To consecrate this vow of brotherhood, they threw all arms of oppression overboard. Cannons were swallowed by the sea in thick gulps; guns and swords bobbed delicately in the wake.

That evening, I was awoken by a crack of wood snapping, followed by screams and fire. We had been overtaken by enemy soldiers; one imagines they were hardly aware of our noble creed. I watched from the porthole men, only seconds before guttation, strain to raise a shattered sail in a white flag of surrender, a dignified attempt to communicate across linguistic borders the eternally sounding aspiration of man's spirit. It was as the craft began to sink that I felt called to join the struggle for peace and brotherhood; failure would only be the most dignified of deaths, and success would be such a miracle as capable of revolutionizing man's relations to man. As I rose to my feet, something must have struck me overboard, for I found myself seated in a ship's boat. Naturally, I began to row, in a fitful attempt to recover those who could still be saved.

Let me cry, shit, suck, enough time that people get attached to me, and then, in the perfect bud of innocence, before the disappointment of my flowering... Too late now to take an active role in it, but if it happens, cool.

Agony: that I was once 18 and had friends... and though my life sucked then, it was attractive, beautiful – it had an *attrait noir*. Now it is normal, nice, healthy, and it's "cool" (to other people) but lacks that "sexual romance" misery brought me... my life is cleanly divided into two periods; the one I am living and the one before. The now is bad and the then was good, forever...

I'm endlessly jealous of our friend Salaïe. I read the periodicals daily. I sweat every night praying and dreading a letter. The fact she was once my age sickens me. My fate as a never-be-her individual shames me, given that she's extrêmement fuckable. Gives me l'ennui. I heard she was on some expedition to les îles inconnues at the behest of secret government contacts. She won't respond to my letters because she is mad at me. I'm sure. She said she'd be away but I know she's mad. I said something inappropriate but not sexual [rude] and she probably decided to stop talking scratch writing. She broke off her engagement to that spy slash anthropologist slash diamond thief.

Which means she's probably having crazy sex in the colonies right now. Touring the harem. Tahitian pussy, I dunno. Still, I hope whoever is coming [mad scientist, chimp army, dinosaur island, Mesmer the terrible], kills me, then everyone, and then leaves her...

You also, obviously. What's the worst thing I ever did to you? Don't tell me, but forgive me and also tell me not to guess. *Angoisse* ! I think: thought -> self-loathing -> obliteration obliteration obliteration. I need a job scratch patron(!) that pays me to write (at which point I'll start writing *tout de suite*!)

I intended to present myself at the salon du loser faggots but was dissuaded at first sniff. They had the air and semblance of shit. Shit under a thin layer of dirt. Shit under a thin layer of leaves. Shit. I'm shit too. Best not to ponder this all too much scratch all. In fact, if you receive this letter, I have killed myself. I plan to kill myself shortly after sending this, and you will be receiving it only for the purposes of posterity, as I have decided to provide an insight into my troubled thoughts, or whatever. It will be by jumping. I will go to the roof and step off onto the pavement. Paving stones. Scratch pavement. Just have friends come by to pick at my stuff. I'll probably be getting drunk first.

I resent that I'll never be a souse, a sot, a sipper, serve a tour in gin alley. I'd be good at it, the stuporous misery, like a perfect peace... I'll just drink enough to stoke that despair then jump.

Sorry about the turn this letter took. Hopefully you'll hear from me again futurally. I mean, for your sake. Frankly I find this whole thing shameful. (Feeling, thinking, doing.)

I hope when you mourn me it will be not as a sister but as a poet.

in blissful repose,
sabyne abimée.



Le fin du monde est là.
Mauvais.

First, there was, as you might expect, siege and occupation. A long period of futile, anxious self-aggrandizement. Everyone got to play soldier; everyone dressed up. Epauettes, swords, whatever was around. Grocery store trips were ennobled with a tone of martial endurance. Trash piled up, sewage piled up, everyone's block belted by trenches of waste.

Sheltering from artillery was attested to be a bawdy, fuck-your-neighbor affair. When the occupation came it was the same but worse. Holocaust centers erected in the square, firing squads, economic depression. The expectations of crisis I had are yet to manifest; I have not been able to exchange food for sex, have not been forced to prostitute myself, etc.

Later, there were the signs: fire in the sky, burning and raging, tak tak tak. Cultists, gangs, mad scientists have all taken to town since. The no-pants set up garrison in the slums but are routinely swept away in fits of bloody massacre by the Fourth Occupation Army. Everywhere you see red posters with block text: MORD.

Here follows a more or less comprehensive inventory of events of the last few months.

DCCCLXXV, Fog

Apple Day: Fifty men hanged for breaking curfew by the Army of National Patriotic Spirit, who shared jurisdiction over the 12th quarter with the Left Grande Armée.

Goose Day: Left Grand Armée passes the Martyrdom Proposal, enacted by the Higher Commission of Victory in the course of events since termed the *Death-on-Parade*.

Pond Spike Day: Potato Day is henceforth to be known as "boot in the pig's throat day," commemorating the bayonet riots of the previous evening.

Hearse Day: Shellings commence.

DCCCLXXV, Frost

Boot in the Pig's Throat Day: Diary depository opens, ¼ lb of butter offered for every entry in service of the historical record.

Beetroot Day: Ameriprussians break the walls, free-shooters take up position, block-to-block fighting commences.

Cricket Day: Currency collapses, accredited to the conversion of gold supply for use in erection of the Central Moloch Complex.

Tuberous Pea Day: Amerip Victory, 10,000 freeshooters committed as burnt offerings following the events of the "Night of Cowardly Betrayal"; see also "Night of Heart's Intuition."

DCCCLXXV, Snow

Salt Day: Administrative Quarter flattened in preparation of the Party, Family, and Fatherland Necropolis (commissioned to appease hungry ghosts).

Lead Day: The Elusive Torturer performs a stunning broad-daylight trolley car heist.

DCCCLXXV, Rain

Snow Drop Day: Comet.

DCCCLXXV, Winds

Common Hedge Mustard Day: Demons.

Circus was in town. I missed the dances, so I went. White scalping shows. Women tied to Saint Andrew's crosses, demonstrations of a procedure to identify the presence of rot blood, a screaming ape elevated on a platform, backlit by arc lamps, a sign beneath in curving red script read: "C'est un Ange!" They should pay me to tell somebody what to put on the signs. "Enlightenment Betrayed." "The Agony of the Mad Monkey." "MAN!" The skyline was bursting, lumpy, bulging, shoddily sloping.

I was invited to a ball-in-stick game which turned out to be an Oscarite affair; the women wore suits, I was told to discard my frock and frill and given a set of trousers. My ill-matched breasts were swiftly noticed and laughed at. For the dance, I was paired with a spitcurl. We waltzed three turns before she was swept away by a dandy-girl. I sat on a table and waited to draw attention. Paper streamers swung across the marble arches. The floor was checkered.